

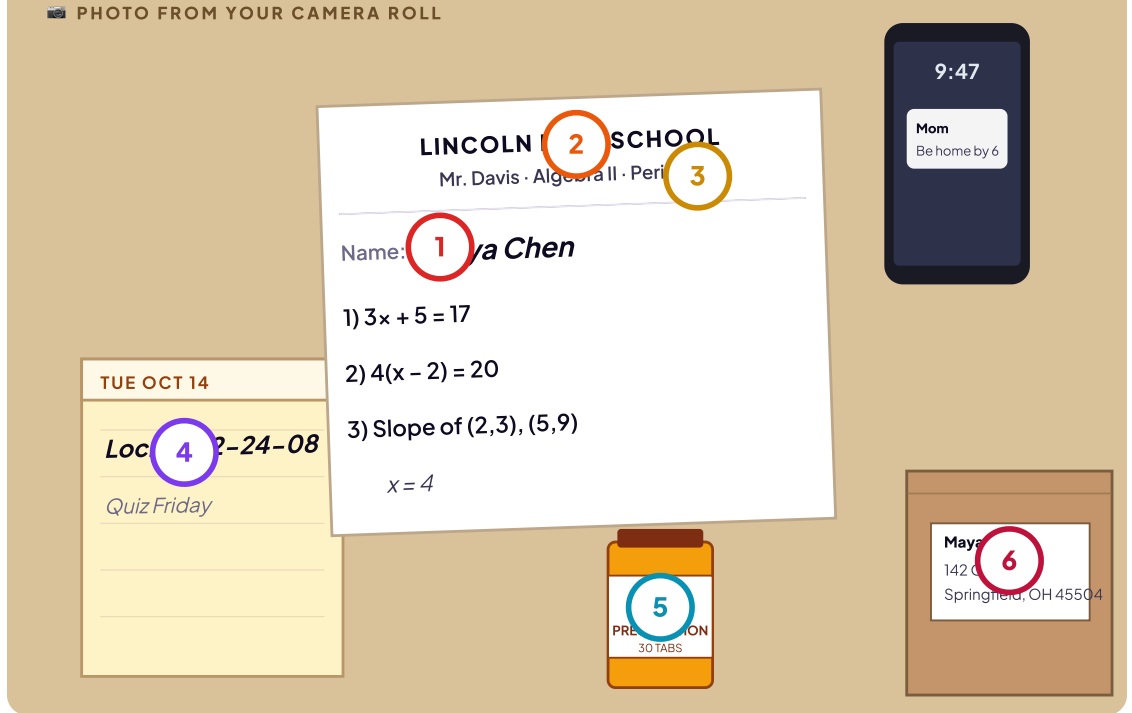
Privacy

The first habit was using AI honestly. The second is guarding what you share with it. Treat AI like a group chat with a company, not a diary. You may be the only person on the screen, but the conversation isn't only yours. Depending on the tool and the settings, what you type can be stored, linked to your account, reviewed for safety, and kept in logs longer than you'd expect. That doesn't mean panic. It means awareness.

And it isn't just text you send. Modern AI is **multimodal**: it can read images, screenshots, PDFs, audio clips, and video. The word means "more than one mode of input." A screenshot is still a prompt. So is a photo, a PDF, or a voice recording. It just looks different. Same context window, same storage rules, same questions about what should and shouldn't be in there.

Picture this. You snap a quick photo of your math homework so AI can help you with one of the problems. You meant to share the math.

The Whole Photo



- 1 Your name**
AI can read handwriting. Your name on the homework page is now in someone's logs.
- 2 Your school**
Lincoln High at the top of the page tells AI exactly where you spend your weekdays.
- 3 Your teacher and class period**
Specific enough to narrow down which classroom you sit in.
- 4 Your locker combination**
You wrote it in the planner so you wouldn't forget. The photo just published it.
- 5 A prescription medication**
Medical info is some of the most sensitive data there is. The bottle was just sitting on the desk.
- 6 Your home street address**
You didn't mean to share this. The shipping label did.

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY SHARED

You meant to share the math. You also shared six other things you didn't think about. The photo was the prompt. Everything in it came with.

WHAT HAPPENS TO YOUR DATA

- Your conversations are saved**
Many AI tools save chat history by default. Whether it's stored, for how long, and whether it can be deleted depends on the tool, the account, and your settings.
- Humans may read them**
Some conversations get reviewed by people: flagged content, safety checks, quality samples, abuse prevention. Not every chat, but a chat isn't as private as a journal either.
- They might train on your data**
Some apps use your conversations to improve future models. That means your words could influence how the model responds to other people.
- Data breaches happen**
In 2023, a ChatGPT bug exposed some users' conversation titles to other users. No system is perfectly secure. The practical rule isn't to panic. It's to keep information out of the chat that you'd hate to see leak.

Share the task, not the identity. The AI usually needs the problem. It usually doesn't need your name, address, password, school login, exact location, private messages, or someone else's sensitive information.

WHEN SAFETY IS INVOLVED

Privacy from AI isn't silence from humans. If a friend may be in danger, get real-world help: a counselor, a parent, or a teacher you trust. Some things need a person, not a prompt.

Run a prompt through these five questions before hitting send.

- 1 What does the AI actually need to help?**
- 2 Can I remove names?**
- 3 Can I replace exact details with categories?**
- 4 Am I sharing someone else's private information?**
- 5 Would I be okay if this appeared in a log?**

WHAT EACH PLATFORM DOES

Last checked: May 2026. These details change as policies update, so treat what's below as a snapshot. Your job is not to memorize today's settings. Your job is to know where to look: privacy settings, data controls, activity history, temporary chat, memory, connected apps, whether your chats can be used for training, and your school account policies.

- ChatGPT (OpenAI)**
 - Conversations may be used to train future models by default (Plus and Pro accounts included)
 - Opt out in Settings → Data Controls → 'Improve the model for everyone'
 - Even after opt-out or deletion, chats may be kept up to 30 days for safety monitoring
 - Temporary Chat isn't saved to your history and isn't used for training

- Claude (Anthropic)**
 - Training is ON by default for Free, Pro, and Max accounts
 - Opt out in Settings → Privacy → 'Help improve Claude'
 - If you don't opt out, conversations can be kept for up to 5 years
 - Anthropic staff may review flagged conversations for safety

- Google Gemini**
 - Conversations are saved and may be used to train Google's AI by default
 - To stop training, turn off 'Gemini Apps Activity' in your Google account
 - Turning that off also means you lose your chat history
 - Conversations chosen for human review are kept for 3 years, even if you delete them

- School-Provided AI Tools**
 - Your school may monitor or log every AI conversation
 - Privacy rules can be different from the consumer version of the same tool
 - Your school's IT department may have access to your history
 - Content filters are usually stricter than the public version

WHAT YOU CAN DO

- Check your settings**
Most platforms let you opt out of training data collection. Find the privacy or data settings and review them. It takes 2 minutes and it's worth it.
- Use temporary chat for one-offs**
Most apps have a temporary or incognito mode that doesn't save to history or memory. Use it for sensitive topics or one-off questions you don't want sitting in your account.
- Crop before you upload**
Screenshots and photos carry everything in the frame: names, school logos, addresses, prescription bottles, locker combinations. Crop tight to what AI actually needs, or type the data instead of uploading the image.
- Audit connected apps**
If AI can read your Gmail, Drive, Photos, Calendar, or browser, the privacy surface goes way past the prompt you typed. Review which apps you've connected and remove any that don't earn the access.
- Delete what you don't need**
Periodically clear your conversation history. If you don't need it anymore, there's no reason for it to sit on someone else's server.
- Use accounts wisely**
If your school provides an AI account, assume it's monitored. For personal use, consider whether you want conversations tied to your real identity or a separate account.

Privacy risk grows the more AI can see. The moment AI can read more than your message (files, email, photos, calendars, documents, web pages), the surface area expands. The hijack risks (prompt injection) come up later, in The Rise of Agents lesson.

Privacy isn't secrecy. It's only sharing the information the task actually requires. Once it's in the chat, you can't take it back.